

MAINS MASTER PROGRAM (MMP) 2024

HANDOUT-16

Issues relating to development & management of social sectors – Health, Education & Human Resources

➤ **Public Health System in India**

- ✓ India's public health system is vast and complex, serving over **1.4 billion people**. It operates at multiple levels, including **central, state, and local governments**, and is primarily funded by public money, although private healthcare plays a significant role
- ✓ **Structure of India's Health System**
 - **Primary Level:** Primary Health Centres (PHCs) and sub-centres serve as the first point of contact, especially in rural areas. PHCs are crucial for preventive and basic curative care.
 - **Secondary Level:** District hospitals and Community Health Centres (CHCs) provide more advanced care, including specialist services.
 - **Tertiary Level:** Large hospitals and medical colleges offer specialized care and are usually located in urban areas. They handle complex cases that require specialized treatments.
- ✓ **Allocation for Health in 2024-25 Budget**
 - In the Union Budget 2024, the Indian government allocated ₹90,658.63 crore to the healthcare sector, marking a 12.59% increase from the previous year's revised estimate. Of this amount, ₹87,656.90 crore is dedicated to the Department of Health and Family Welfare, while ₹3,301.73 crore is allocated to the Department of Health Research.
 - Despite this increase, the healthcare budget still falls short of the **National Health Policy 2017** target, which aims to allocate at **least 2.5% of GDP** to healthcare by 2025. Currently, public health spending in India is **around 2.1-2.2% of GDP**, which is lower than the global average.

➤ **Evolution of India's Health Program**

- ✓ **Pre-Independence Phase (Before 1947)**
 - **Focus:** Control of communicable diseases like malaria, plague, cholera, and smallpox.
 - **Key Initiatives:** Establishment of health institutions such as hospitals and research centres.
 - **Health infrastructure:** Minimal, with health services primarily in urban areas.
- ✓ **Post-Independence Phase (1947-1960s)**
 - **Primary Focus:** Disease control, maternal and child health.
 - **Key Initiatives:** National programs for diseases like malaria (National Malaria Control Programme, 1953), smallpox, and tuberculosis, Family planning program etc.

- **Infrastructure Development:** Establishment of primary health centres (PHCs) and sub-centres in rural areas.
 - ✓ **Community Health Approach (1970s-1980s)**
 - **Focus:** Primary healthcare and rural health services.
 - **Key Initiatives:** National Health Policy (1983), Integrated Child Development Services (ICDS) (1975), Rural Health Mission (1977), Expanded immunization programs (1978) etc.
 - ✓ **Reproductive and Child Health Phase (1990s)**
 - **Focus:** Reproductive health, child survival, and safe motherhood.
 - **Key Programs:** Reproductive and Child Health (RCH) Programme (1997), National AIDS Control Program (1992) etc.
 - ✓ **National Rural Health Mission (NRHM) (2005-2013)**
 - **Focus:** Strengthening rural healthcare services and addressing regional health disparities.
 - **Key Components:** Infrastructure development in rural areas, Increase in the number of PHCs, sub-centres, and community health workers (ASHA - Accredited Social Health Activists) etc.
 - ✓ **National Health Policy (2017) – present**
 - **Focus:** Universal healthcare, reducing out-of-pocket expenditure, and improving access to quality healthcare services.
 - **Key Initiatives:**
 - a) **Ayushman Bharat (2018-Present)** with two-pronged strategy - Health and Wellness Centres (HWCs) & Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (PM-JAY).
 - b) **National Digital Health Mission (NDHM)** with objective of creating digital health ecosystem & promoting telemedicine services
 - c) **Integration of traditional systems of medicine (AYUSH)**
- **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) of ensuring Good Health & well being**
- ✓ The **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)**, adopted by the United Nations in 2015, provide a global blueprint for achieving a better and more sustainable future.
 - ✓ **Key Targets under SDGs [2030]**
 - **Reduce Maternal Mortality:** reduce the global maternal mortality ratio to less than **70 per 100,000 live births**.
 - **End Preventable Deaths of New-borns and Children:** end preventable deaths of new-borns and children under 5 years, aiming to reduce neonatal mortality to at least **12 per 1,000 live births** and under-5 mortality to at least **25 per 1,000 live births**.
 - **Fight Communicable Diseases:** end epidemics of **AIDS, tuberculosis, malaria, and neglected tropical diseases** and combat **hepatitis, water-borne diseases, and other communicable diseases**.

- **Reduce Mortality from Non-Communicable Diseases:** reduce by one-third premature mortality from non-communicable diseases (NCDs) through prevention, treatment, and promoting mental health and well-being.
- **Prevent and Treat Substance Abuse:** Strengthen the prevention and treatment of **substance abuse**, including narcotic drug abuse and harmful use of alcohol.
- **Reduce Road Traffic Accidents:** halve the number of global deaths and injuries from road traffic accidents.
- **Universal Access to Sexual and Reproductive Health Services:** ensure universal access to sexual and reproductive health-care services, including family planning, information, and education, as well as the integration of reproductive health into national strategies and programs.
- **Achieve Universal Health Coverage:** Achieve universal health coverage (UHC), including financial risk protection, access to quality essential healthcare services, and access to safe, effective, quality, and affordable essential medicines and vaccines for all.
- **Reduce Pollution-Related Deaths:** substantially reduce the number of deaths and illnesses from hazardous chemicals and air, water, and soil pollution and contamination.

➤ **Important Govt. Initiatives regarding Health**

- ✓ **National Health Mission**
- ✓ **Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (PMJAY – Ayushman Bharat)**
- ✓ **Pradhan Mantri Swasthya Suraksha Yojana (PMSSY)**
- ✓ **Pradhan Mantri Swasthya Suraksha Nidhi (PMSSN)**
- ✓ **Pradhan Mantri Atma Nirbhar Swasth Bharat Yojana (PMANSBY)**
- ✓ **National Digital Health Mission (NDHM)**

➤ **National Health Mission**

- ✓ The **National Health Mission (NHM)** is a flagship program launched by the Government of India in 2013 to improve healthcare delivery across the country.
- ✓ The NHM was created by merging the **National Rural Health Mission (NRHM)** and the **National Urban Health Mission (NUHM)** to address both rural and urban health challenges comprehensively.
- ✓ **Objectives of the National Health Mission**
 - **Universal Access to Health Services:** The NHM aims to provide equitable, affordable, and quality healthcare services to all citizens, with a focus on vulnerable populations and under-served areas. It seeks to reduce the disparities in healthcare access and improve the health outcomes of the population, particularly in rural and remote areas.
 - **Strengthening Health Systems:** The mission focuses on strengthening public health infrastructure, including primary, secondary, and tertiary care facilities. It

emphasizes capacity building, enhancing the availability of skilled healthcare personnel, and improving supply chains for essential medicines and equipment.

- **Reproductive, Maternal, New-born, Child, and Adolescent Health (RMNCH+A):** A key focus area of NHM is RMNCH+A, which aims to reduce maternal and infant mortality rates, improve adolescent health, and address the health needs of women and children. The mission promotes institutional deliveries, immunization, and nutritional support, among other initiatives, to improve health outcomes in these areas.
- **Communicable and Non-Communicable Diseases:** The NHM includes programs for the prevention and control of communicable diseases (like tuberculosis, malaria, and HIV/AIDS) as well as non-communicable diseases (like diabetes, hypertension, and cancer). It seeks to integrate health services to address the dual burden of diseases in India.
- **Community Participation and Ownership:** The NHM encourages community participation in health governance through institutions like Village Health, Sanitation, and Nutrition Committees (VHSNCs). It also promotes health awareness and behavioural change communication to involve communities in health planning and decision-making.
- **Health Financing and Insurance:** The mission promotes financial protection for the poor by expanding health insurance coverage and reducing out-of-pocket expenditures on healthcare. It includes the implementation of schemes like the Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (PM-JAY), which provides financial protection for secondary and tertiary healthcare services to economically disadvantaged populations.

✓ **Key Components of the NHM:**

- **National Rural Health Mission (NRHM):** Launched in 2005, NRHM focuses on rural health with special attention to high-focus states and regions with weak public health indicators. It aims to strengthen rural healthcare infrastructure, ensure the availability of trained healthcare professionals, and improve maternal and child health services.
- **National Urban Health Mission (NUHM):** Introduced in 2013, NUHM targets the health needs of the urban poor, including slum dwellers and other marginalized urban populations. It seeks to improve urban healthcare infrastructure, enhance the delivery of primary healthcare services, and address the health needs of urban residents, particularly in underserved areas.
- **AYUSH and Public Health Systems:** The NHM integrates AYUSH (Ayurveda, Yoga, Unani, Siddha, and Homeopathy) with mainstream health services to offer a holistic approach to healthcare. It also focuses on strengthening public health systems and increasing the availability of essential drugs and diagnostics.

✓ **Achievements and Challenges:**

- **Achievements:** Significant progress has been made in improving maternal and child health indicators, increasing immunization coverage, and reducing communicable diseases. The mission has expanded healthcare infrastructure, particularly in rural areas, and has improved the availability of essential drugs and diagnostics.
- **Challenges:** Despite progress, challenges remain, including disparities in healthcare access between states and regions, workforce shortages, and the need for greater financial resources to meet the growing demand for health services. The mission continues to face issues related to the quality of care, particularly in public health facilities, and the need for better governance and accountability mechanisms.

➤ **Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (PM-JAY)**

- ✓ Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (PM-JAY) also known as **Ayushman Bharat**, is a flagship health insurance scheme launched by the Government of India in September 2018.
- ✓ It is a key component of the Ayushman Bharat initiative, which aims to achieve **Universal Health Coverage (UHC)** and address the healthcare needs of the vulnerable sections of society.
- ✓ **Key Features of PM-JAY**
 - **Health Coverage:** PM-JAY provides a health insurance cover of up to ₹5 lakh per family per year for secondary and tertiary care hospitalization. The scheme covers over 1,500 medical procedures, including surgeries, day care treatments, and follow-up care.
 - **Beneficiary Coverage:** The scheme targets more than 100 million poor and vulnerable families, covering approximately 500 million individuals. Beneficiaries are identified based on the Socio-Economic Caste Census (SECC) 2011 data. It is fully funded by the government, with the costs shared between the central and state governments.
 - **Cashless and Paperless Access:** Beneficiaries of PM-JAY can avail themselves of cashless and paperless healthcare services at any empanelled public or private hospital across India. The scheme is portable, meaning beneficiaries can seek treatment in any state.
 - **Empanelled Hospitals:** Both public and private hospitals across India can be empanelled under the scheme, provided they meet the criteria set by the government. Empanelled hospitals must adhere to quality standards and provide the services covered under PM-JAY.
 - **Focus on Preventive and Promotive Health:** PM-JAY also includes provisions for wellness and preventive healthcare services, aiming to reduce the overall burden of disease in the country.

- **Implementation and Monitoring:** The scheme is implemented by the National Health Authority (NHA) at the national level and by State Health Agencies (SHAs) at the state level. The NHA is responsible for policy formulation, while SHAs oversee the implementation within their respective states. The scheme uses robust IT systems for seamless processing, including beneficiary identification, claims management, and hospital empanelment.

✓ **Achievements and Impact:**

- **Widespread Coverage:** Since its inception, PM-JAY has enabled millions of beneficiaries to access quality healthcare services without financial hardship. The scheme has played a crucial role in reducing out-of-pocket expenditures on healthcare.
- **Improved Healthcare Access:** By empanelling private hospitals, PM-JAY has significantly increased access to healthcare services, particularly in areas where public healthcare infrastructure is lacking.
- **Enhanced Focus on Health:** The scheme has led to increased awareness about health insurance and preventive healthcare among the population, contributing to improved health outcomes.

✓ **Challenges**

- **Awareness and Outreach:** Despite the scale of the program, there are still challenges related to awareness among potential beneficiaries, leading to underutilization in some regions.
- **Fraud and Abuse:** The scheme faces challenges in preventing fraud and abuse, such as false claims and overcharging by hospitals.
- **Sustainability:** Ensuring the financial sustainability of such a large-scale health insurance program is a continuing challenge, particularly as healthcare costs rise.

➤ **Pradhan Mantri Swasthya Suraksha Yojana (PMSSY)**

- ✓ The **Pradhan Mantri Swasthya Suraksha Yojana (PMSSY)** is a significant initiative launched by the Government of India in 2003 to strengthen the healthcare infrastructure and address regional imbalances in the availability of affordable and reliable tertiary healthcare services.

✓ **Objectives of the Scheme**

- **Establishing AIIMS-like Institutions:** One of the primary goals of PMSSY is to establish new All India Institutes of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) in various states. These institutions are intended to provide high-quality medical education and tertiary healthcare services, similar to the original AIIMS in New Delhi.
- **Upgrading Government Medical Colleges:** PMSSY also focuses on upgrading existing government medical colleges and institutions. This involves adding new specialty departments, improving infrastructure, and increasing the availability of advanced medical equipment.

- **Reducing Regional Disparities:** By establishing AIIMS-like institutions and upgrading medical colleges in underserved areas, PMSSY aims to reduce regional disparities in healthcare access and improve the overall health infrastructure in the country.
- **Enhancing Medical Education:** The scheme also emphasizes improving the quality of medical education by increasing the number of postgraduate seats, providing better training facilities, and ensuring that medical colleges have the necessary infrastructure and faculty.
- ✓ **Phases of Implementation:**
 - **Phase I:** In the first phase, six new AIIMS were established in states like Bihar, Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh, Odisha, Rajasthan, and Uttarakhand. Additionally, 13 government medical colleges were upgraded.
 - **Phase II and Beyond:** In subsequent phases, more AIIMS institutions were established, and additional government medical colleges were upgraded. As of the latest updates, over 20 AIIMS institutions are being established across India, and many more medical colleges have been upgraded.
- ✓ **Key Components of the Yojana:**
 - **Infrastructure Development:** PMSSY involves significant investment in infrastructure development, including the construction of new hospital buildings, academic blocks, and residential facilities for students and staff at the AIIMS institutions.
 - **Procurement of Medical Equipment:** The scheme ensures that AIIMS institutions and upgraded medical colleges are equipped with state-of-the-art medical equipment to provide high-quality healthcare services and training.
 - **Faculty Development:** To improve the quality of medical education, PMSSY includes provisions for the recruitment and training of qualified faculty members. It also supports research and innovation in medical sciences.
- ✓ **Impact of the Scheme**
 - **Improved Healthcare Access:** The establishment of new AIIMS institutions and the upgrading of medical colleges have significantly improved access to tertiary healthcare services in various regions, particularly in states that previously lacked such facilities.
 - **Enhanced Medical Education:** By increasing the number of medical seats and improving training facilities, PMSSY has contributed to the overall improvement in the quality of medical education in India.
 - **Regional Development:** The scheme has also contributed to the socio-economic development of the regions where new AIIMS institutions have been established, by creating employment opportunities and improving local infrastructure.
- ✓ **Challenges:**

- **Project Delays:** Some AIIMS projects have faced delays due to land acquisition issues, construction challenges, and administrative hurdles, affecting the timely implementation of the scheme.
- **Operational Challenges:** Newly established AIIMS institutions often face challenges related to faculty recruitment, equipment procurement, and operational management in their initial years.

➤ **Pradhan Mantri Swasthya Suraksha Nidhi (PMSSN)**

- ✓ It is a **non-lapsable reserve fund** created to enhance health infrastructure and services in India.
- ✓ The fund is meant to ensure that resources collected from health-related taxes, particularly the Health and Education Cess, are used exclusively for improving the country's healthcare system.
- ✓ **Key Features**
 - **Non-Lapsable Reserve Fund:** The fund is created in the Public Account of India, and the money will not lapse at the end of the financial year. It ensures continuous and dedicated funding for healthcare.
 - **Source of Funding:** The fund is primarily financed through the proceeds of the **Health and Education Cess**, which is currently 4% on the income tax.
 - **Utilization of Funds:** The resources from the PMSSN are used for the following health programs:
 - 1) **Ayushman Bharat – Health and Wellness Centres (AB-HWCs):** Upgrading primary healthcare infrastructure and services.
 - 2) **Ayushman Bharat – Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (PM-JAY):** A health insurance scheme providing free coverage to vulnerable families.
 - 3) **Emergency and disaster preparedness, including pandemic response:** Ensuring readiness for healthcare crises like COVID-19.
 - 4) **National Health Mission (NHM):** Enhancing rural and urban healthcare services across India.
 - 5) Any future flagship health program initiated by the Government of India.

➤ **Pradhan Mantri Atma Nirbhar Swasth Bharat Yojana (PMANSBY)**

- ✓ The **Pradhan Mantri Atma Nirbhar Swasth Bharat Yojana (PMANSBY)**, later renamed **Pradhan Mantri Ayushman Bharat Health Infrastructure Mission (PM-ABHIM)**, was launched by government of India in 2021.
- ✓ This scheme is a part of India's efforts to **strengthen its healthcare infrastructure and achieve self-reliance in the health sector**, especially in the wake of the COVID-19 pandemic.
- ✓ **Key Objectives of PM-ABHIM (PMANSBY)**
 - 1) **Strengthen Critical Healthcare Infrastructure** at **primary, secondary & tertiary level** and to build capacity to deal with **future health emergency & pandemics**.

- 2) **Develop Health Systems at the Grassroots Level** with focus on establishing **health & wellness centres** in rural & urban areas along **with diagnostic & treatment facilities** including non-communicable diseases.
- 3) **Training of Healthcare Professionals**
- 4) **Expansion of Public Health Institutions** with special focus on institutions such as **National Centre for Disease Control (NCDC)**, **Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)**, and **National Institutes of Virology (NIV)** to enhance their role in monitoring, diagnosing, and controlling infectious diseases.

✓ **Components of the Scheme**

- Health Infrastructure Strengthening
- Disease Surveillance and Data Management
- Public Health Workforce Development

✓ **Importance of PM-ABHIM**

- **Preparedness for pandemic & emergencies:** The scheme was launched in response to the COVID-19 pandemic and is designed to strengthen India's ability to respond to future pandemics and health crises.
- **Rural Health Focus:** It aims to improve access to quality healthcare in rural and underserved areas, bridging the urban-rural health divide.
- **Self-Reliant Health Sector:** By investing in infrastructure, human resources, and disease surveillance, the mission seeks to make India more self-reliant in healthcare.

➤ **National Digital Health Mission (NDHM)**

- ✓ The **National Digital Health Mission (NDHM)**, now called the **Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM)**, is a flagship initiative by the Government of India to digitize healthcare and create an integrated healthcare ecosystem in the country.

✓ **Key Objectives of NDHM (ABDM)**

- Digital Health Ecosystem
- Health ID for Every Citizen & Digital Health record
- Healthcare Professionals Registry (HPR)
- Health Facility Registry (HFR)
- Consent-Based Data Exchange

✓ **Importance of NDHM**

- Improved Healthcare Access
- Efficiency in Healthcare Delivery
- Continuity of Care
- Data-Driven Health Decisions
- Pandemic and Emergency Response

✓ **Challenges of the Mission**

- Data Privacy and Security
- Digital Divide
- Technical barriers related to interoperability of information

- **Key issues & challenges in India's health care sector**
 - ✓ **High Out-of-Pocket Expenditure**
 - Initiative – Ayushman Bharat
 - ✓ **Inadequate Health Infrastructure & workforce**
 - Initiative - Pradhan Mantri Ayushman Bharat Health Infrastructure Mission
 - ✓ **Burden of Communicable and Non-Communicable Diseases & poor preventive care**
 - Initiative – Ayushman Bharat, National Health Mission etc.
 - ✓ **Health inequality & regional disparity**
 - Initiative - Pradhan Mantri Swasthya Suraksha Yojana (PMSSY)
 - ✓ **Poor Public Health Spending (< 2.5 % of GDP)**
 - Initiative - Pradhan Mantri Swasthya Suraksha Nidhi (PMSSN)
 - ✓ **Lack of Health Awareness and Education**
 - Ayushman Bharat - Health and Wellness Centres (AB-HWCs); National Health Mission (NHM) etc.
 - ✓ **Corruption and Mismanagement**
 - Initiatives - Whistle-blower Protection and Citizen Grievance Mechanisms, Centralized Public Procurement Portal, Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (PMJAY) - Anti-Fraud Framework etc.
 - ✓ **Poor Health Data Management**
 - Initiative – National Digital Health Mission
 - ✓ **Neglect of mental Health**
 - Initiative – Mental health care act, 2017; National Mental health care program.
 - ✓ **Weak preparedness for pandemic & emergencies**
 - Initiative - Pradhan Mantri Ayushman Bharat Health Infrastructure Mission (PM-ABHIM)
- **Way forward for Indian Health sector**
 - ✓ The way forward for India's health sector lies in a holistic approach that integrates **better financing, infrastructure improvement, digital innovation, workforce strengthening, and community involvement.**
 - ✓ Focusing on these key areas, India can move closer to achieving **universal health coverage** and ensuring better health outcomes for its population, particularly the underserved and vulnerable.

Questions

1. What are the various Sustainable Development Goals related to health? Identify some of the initiatives taken by the government in this regard [10]
2. Public health system has limitation in providing universal health coverage. Do you think that private sector can help in bridging the gap? What other viable alternatives do you suggest? [10]

3. What are the various issues & challenges affecting the Indian Health sector? Identify some the measures taken by government to address them. [10]
4. Pradhan Mantri Ayushman Bharat Health Infrastructure Mission (PM-ABHIM) was launched with an objective of strengthening its healthcare infrastructure and achieving self-reliance in the health sector. Comment [10]

➤ **Public Education system in India**

- ✓ The public education system in India is vast and diverse, aiming to provide education to over a billion people.

- ✓ **Structure of Public Education System in India**

- 1) **Pre-Primary Education:**

- a) **Anganwadi:** For children aged 3-6, these are government-run early childhood care and education centres.

- b) **Preschools/Play Schools:** Private institutions offering early education before formal schooling.

- 2) **Primary Education:** Classes I-V generally, for children aged 6-11. The focus is on basic literacy and numeracy.

- 3) **Upper Primary Education:** Classes VI-VIII for children aged 11-14. Curriculum expands to include subjects like science, social studies, and languages.

- 4) **Secondary Education:** Classes IX-X for students aged 14-16. More specialized subjects and preparation for higher education.

- 5) **Higher Secondary Education:** Classes XI-XII for students aged 16-18. Offers streams like Science, Commerce, and Humanities.

- 6) **Tertiary Education**

- a) **Undergraduate:** Various degrees in arts, science, commerce, and professional fields.

- b) **Postgraduate:** Master's and doctoral programs.

- ✓ **Governance and Curriculum**

- 1) **Central and State Boards:** Education is managed by both central and state governments. The Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) and the Council for the Indian School Certificate Examinations (CISCE) are two prominent national boards. States also have their own education boards.

- 2) **National Curriculum Framework (NCF):** Provides guidelines for developing curriculum at various educational levels.

- ✓ **Administrative structure of Ministry of Education**

- 1) **Department of School Education and Literacy:** Manages policies and programs related to elementary, secondary, and higher secondary education.

- 2) **Department of Higher Education:** Oversees higher education, including colleges and universities.

- 3) **National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT):** Develops and publishes curriculum and textbooks for school education, conducts educational research, and provides training to teachers.

4) **University Grants Commission (UGC)**: Regulates and coordinates university education, allocates funds, and ensures quality assurance in higher education.

5) **All India Council for Technical Education (AICTE)**: Regulates technical education and accredits institutions offering technical courses like engineering and management.

✓ **Key objectives of the ministry**

- National Level policy on education
- Planned development including improved access to education
- Paying special attention to disadvantaged groups
- Providing financial help to the deprived sections
- Promote international cooperation in the field of education

➤ **Attention to Education in Budget 2024-25**

- ✓ In India's Union Budget 2024, education has received significant attention with an allocation of **₹1.48 lakh crore** aimed at enhancing the education and skill development sectors.
- ✓ This is a **notable increase compared to the previous year**, reflecting the government's focus on improving both school and higher education as well as creating employment opportunities.
- ✓ The government also aims to boost skill development and job creation, focusing on training **20 lakh youth** over five years and launching a scheme to provide internships for **1 crore students** with a stipend of ₹5,000 per month
- ✓ Additionally, provisions are made for **higher education loans** of up to ₹10 lakh for domestic institutions, with a 3% interest subvention

➤ **Major Initiatives Department of School Education & Literacy**

- ✓ National Education Policy, 2020
- ✓ Right to Education Act, 2009
- ✓ STARS Project [Strengthening Teaching-Learning and Results for States]
- ✓ PM SHRI schools [PM SHRI schools]

➤ **National Education Policy, 2020**

- ✓ The National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 is a comprehensive framework aimed at overhauling and modernizing the Indian education system
- ✓ **Goals and Objectives of the Policy**
 - **Holistic Education**: To provide a well-rounded education that goes beyond traditional academic learning, integrating life skills, critical thinking, and creativity.
 - **Quality Improvement**: To improve the quality of education at all levels by focusing on teacher training, curriculum reforms, and infrastructure development.

- **Inclusivity:** To ensure that education is accessible to all, regardless of socio-economic status, gender, or disability.
- **Technology Integration:** To leverage technology for better learning outcomes and to enhance educational access and quality.
- **Global Standards:** To align the Indian education system with global best practices and prepare students for a globalized world.

✓ **Key Features of the Policy**

1) Changes in school education: Focus Areas - Curriculum and Pedagogy, use of technology to facilitate online learning [National Educational Technology Forum (NETF)], objective assessment methods [National Assessment Centre], focus on vocational education

2) Higher Education:

- Higher education with flexible curricula, credit-based systems, and multiple entry and exit points.
- **Higher Education Commission of India (HECI):** Establishment of a single overarching umbrella body to govern higher education, replacing existing regulatory agencies like the UGC, AICTE, and others.
- **National Educational Technology Forum (NETF):** To support the development and use of educational technology.
- **Higher Education Financing Agency (HEFA):** To fund infrastructure projects in higher education institutions.

3) Teacher Education and Training: Emphasis on enhancing teacher quality and training, including a move towards a four-year integrated B.Ed. program.

4) Language Policy: Encourages the study of multiple languages and promotes the use of the mother tongue or local language as the medium of instruction up to Grade V, and beyond if feasible.

5) Inclusivity and Accessibility: Education for All - Special focus on marginalized groups including Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes, minorities, and children with disabilities.

6) Assessment and Examination

- **National Assessment Framework (NAF):** To reform the assessment system with a focus on learning outcomes and skills rather than rote memorization.
- **Board Exams:** Reducing the pressure of board exams by making them more flexible and less frequent.

➤ **Right to Education (RTE) Act of 2009**

- ✓ RTE Act is a landmark legislation in India that guarantees free and compulsory education to children between the ages of 6 and 14.

- ✓ The Act aims to provide equal opportunities for quality education to all children and ensure that they have access to schooling, regardless of their socio-economic background.

- ✓ **Key Provisions of the RTE Act, 2009**

- 1) **Free and Compulsory Education:** Every child aged 6-14 has the right to free and compulsory elementary education in a neighbourhood school
- 2) **Reservation in Private Schools:** Private unaided schools are required to reserve 25% of seats at the entry-level (Class 1 or pre-school) for children from economically weaker sections (EWS) and disadvantaged groups
- 3) **Neighbourhood Schools:** Schools must be located within a reasonable distance from the child's home. The state government is responsible for establishing sufficient schools to ensure access.
- 4) **Infrastructure Norms:** The Act mandates specific infrastructure standards for schools, including adequate teacher-student ratios, proper classrooms, toilets, drinking water facilities, playgrounds, and a library.
- 5) **No Detention Policy:** No child shall be held back in any class or expelled from school until the completion of elementary education. The focus is on **continuous and comprehensive evaluation (CCE)** rather than traditional exams.
- 6) **Teacher Qualification and Training:** The Act sets minimum qualifications for teachers and emphasizes the need for trained and qualified teachers in schools.
- 7) **Curriculum and Learning:** The curriculum is to be child-centred and activity-based, encouraging children's all-around development in a stress-free environment. Schools should follow the guidelines set by the National Curriculum Framework (NCF).
- 8) **Prohibition of Discrimination and Harassment:** No child shall be subjected to any form of physical punishment or mental harassment. Discrimination based on caste, gender, or socio-economic background is strictly prohibited.
- 9) **School Management Committees (SMC):** The Act provides special focus on the inclusion of children from marginalized communities such as Scheduled Castes (SC), Scheduled Tribes (ST), and children with disabilities.
- 10) **Grievance Redressal Mechanism:** The Act provides a mechanism for addressing complaints about violations of the RTE provisions, with local authorities and educational officers responsible for grievance redressal.

- ✓ **Assessment of the RTE Act**

- Significant achievements in terms of - **Increased Enrolment, Access to Education, Improved Infrastructure and Teacher Training.**
- Challenges – **Poor learning outcomes, Teacher-student ratio, dropout rates, implementation in private schools, controversy over no-detention policy & poor grievance redressal mechanism.**
- **Recent Amendment** - In 2019, the government amended the RTE Act to allow states to conduct examinations in Classes 5 and 8 and retain students if they do

not pass the exam, with provisions for re-examinations. This amendment aimed to address concerns about declining learning outcomes under the no-detention policy.

➤ Higher Education in India

- ✓ **Higher Education in India** plays a pivotal role in shaping the country's socio-economic development, as it provides the advanced skills and knowledge necessary for innovation and growth.
- ✓ India's higher education system is one of the largest in the world, with a vast network of universities, colleges, and institutes offering education in various disciplines.
- ✓ **Structure of Higher Education in India**
 - **Types of Institutions:**
 - 1) **Central Universities:** Funded by the Government of India (e.g., University of Delhi, Jawaharlal Nehru University).
 - 2) **State Universities:** Funded by state governments (e.g., University of Mumbai, University of Madras).
 - 3) **Deemed-to-be Universities:** Granted autonomy by the University Grants Commission (UGC) but not categorized as full-fledged universities.
 - 4) **Private Universities:** Funded and operated by private entities but regulated by government bodies.
 - 5) **Institutes of National Importance:** Specialized institutes such as the Indian Institutes of Technology (IITs), National Institutes of Technology (NITs), and Indian Institutes of Management (IIMs).
 - **Regulatory Bodies:**
 - 1) **University Grants Commission (UGC):** Responsible for coordinating, determining, and maintaining the standards of higher education.
 - 2) **All India Council for Technical Education (AICTE):** Governs technical and engineering education.
 - 3) **National Medical Commission (NMC):** Regulate medical education.
 - 4) **National Assessment and Accreditation Council (NAAC):** Accredits institutions and evaluates their quality.
- ✓ **Challenges & issues related to Higher Education in India**
 - 1) **Quality of Education:** Despite having a large number of higher education institutions, the **quality of education** remains uneven. Many institutions face problems like outdated curricula, inadequate infrastructure, and lack of qualified faculty, resulting in a gap between graduates' skills and industry needs.
 - 2) **Funding and Infrastructure:** The funding for higher education is insufficient, especially in state universities and public colleges, leading to poor infrastructure, lack of laboratories, and limited access to digital learning tools. Private institutions are better funded but often expensive and inaccessible to lower-income groups.
 - 3) **Access and Equity:** There are **regional disparities** in access to higher education, with urban areas having far more options than rural areas. Additionally, **gender**,

caste, and socio-economic inequalities persist, though government schemes like **reservation policies** and scholarships aim to bridge these gaps.

- 4) **Skill Mismatch:** There is a significant **skill gap** between the curriculum taught in higher education institutions and the skills demanded by industries, especially in sectors like technology and management. Graduates often lack practical skills, leading to unemployability issues.
- 5) **Regulatory Framework:** The higher education system is highly regulated, which often leads to bureaucratic delays in decision-making. The multiplicity of regulatory bodies like the UGC, AICTE, and NMC can create overlapping rules and hinder the autonomy of institutions.
- 6) **Limited Research Output:** India's share of global research output remains low compared to other countries. While institutions like IITs and IISc produce quality research, the majority of colleges and universities focus on teaching rather than research, limiting innovation and scientific progress.

✓ **Recent Reforms and Initiatives related to Higher Education**

1) **National Education Policy (NEP) 2020:**

- a) A **multidisciplinary approach** with flexible curricula.
- b) Establishment of a **Higher Education Commission of India (HECI)** to replace multiple regulatory bodies like UGC and AICTE.
- c) Promotion of **research** through the creation of the **National Research Foundation (NRF)**.
- d) Emphasis on **vocational education**, making internships and apprenticeships part of degree programs.
- e) Creation of **multidisciplinary institutions** and the phasing out of standalone specialized institutions.
- f) **Autonomy for higher education institutions** to design their curricula, faculty recruitment, and student admission processes.

2) **Rashtriya Uchchatar Shiksha Abhiyan (RUSA):** A centrally sponsored scheme aimed at improving the **quality of higher education** by providing funding to state universities and colleges. RUSA focuses on improving infrastructure, ensuring faculty development, and promoting innovation in state-run institutions.

3) **Institutions of Eminence (IoE):** The **Institutions of Eminence (IoE)** initiative seeks to elevate Indian universities to global standards. Selected universities receive more autonomy and funding, with the goal of placing Indian institutions among the top global rankings.

4) **Study in India:** The **Study in India** initiative aims to attract international students to Indian universities, enhancing global collaborations and the internationalization of India's higher education system.

5) **Digital Initiatives:** With the rise of digital learning, platforms like **SWAYAM** (Study Webs of Active-Learning for Young Aspiring Minds) and **National Digital Library of India (NDLI)** offer free online courses and resources to students, improving access to quality education.

- **Sustainable Development Goals: Quality Education [2030]**
 - ✓ **Universal Primary and Secondary Education**
 - **Initiative** - India's **Right to Education (RTE) Act 2009** guarantees free and compulsory education for children aged 6-14.
 - ✓ **Early Childhood Development and Pre-primary Education**
 - **Initiative** - India's **Integrated Child Development Services (ICDS)** program offers preschool education and nutrition services to children under 6.
 - Efforts are underway to strengthen early education under the **National Education Policy (NEP) 2020**, which emphasizes **foundational literacy and numeracy** in early education.
 - ✓ **Technical, Vocational, and Higher Education:** Targets equal access to affordable technical, vocational, and higher education.
 - **Initiatives** - India's vocational education and training programs, like the **Skill India Mission**, aim to improve access to vocational training. The **Rashtriya Uchchatar Shiksha Abhiyan (RUSA)** helps improve higher education infrastructure.
 - ✓ **Gender Equality in Education:** Emphasizes eliminating gender disparities in education.
 - **Initiatives** - **Beti Bachao Beti Padhao** campaign aim to increase girls' enrolment and reduce dropout rates, while **scholarship schemes** for girls encourage higher education participation.
 - ✓ **Improvement in Learning Outcomes**
 - **Initiatives** - The **NEP 2020** and **Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan** focus on improving teaching methods and enhancing the quality of education across schools.
 - ✓ **Inclusive and Equitable Education**
 - The **NEP 2020** stresses inclusivity, aiming to provide equal access to marginalized groups, including rural and tribal populations
 - Programs targeting **Scheduled Castes (SCs)**, **Scheduled Tribes (STs)**, and **Other Backward Classes (OBCs)** aim to reduce inequality in education.

Questions

1. **Right to Education Act, 2009** has made significant strides in ensuring universal access to primary education & addressing the needs of the disadvantaged. Discuss [10]
 2. Identify the various SDGs related to education & also initiatives taken by the government in that regard with special reference to NEP 2020. [10]
 3. What are the various challenges related to Higher Education System in India? Suggest suitable reforms to address them. [10]
- **Human Resource & Skill Development in India**
 - ✓ The Ministry of Education (formerly known as the Ministry of Human Resource Development) is the central government ministry in India responsible for overseeing and implementing policies related to education and human resource development.

- ✓ It plays a crucial role in shaping the education system and workforce development across the country
- ✓ **Skill development** refers to the process of **acquiring or improving abilities** and competencies that are essential for performing specific tasks or roles effectively.
- ✓ It encompasses a wide range of activities aimed at enhancing both technical and soft skills, enabling individuals to meet the demands of their current or future jobs.
- ✓ Skill development is crucial for personal growth, career advancement, and overall economic progress.

✓ **Components of Skill Development**

- 1) **Education and Training:** Formal education (e.g., degrees and diplomas) and specialized training programs (e.g., certifications and workshops) provide the foundational knowledge and skills needed for various professions.
- 2) **On-the-Job Training:** Practical experience gained through work allows individuals to develop and refine their skills in a real-world context.
- 3) **Vocational Training:** Focuses on specific trades or professions, providing hands-on skills that are directly applicable to particular careers.
- 4) **Mentorship and Coaching:** Guidance from experienced professionals can help individuals develop their skills, gain insights into their field, and navigate career challenges.

✓ **Important Institutional & Organisational set up & Schemes related to skill development in India**

- National Council for Vocational Education & Training
- National Skill Development Corporation
- National Skill Development Fund
- Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY)
- SANKALP [Skill Acquisition and Knowledge Awareness for Livelihood Promotion]
- STRIVE [Skill Strengthening for Industrial Value Enhancement]
- National Skill Development Policy, 2015

➤ **Skill Development & Budget 2024-25**

- ✓ Skill development in India is a key focus area for the government, aimed at improving employability, boosting economic growth, and addressing the skills gap in various sectors.
- ✓ The Budget for 2024-25 likely includes specific provisions and initiatives related to skill development.

✓ **Budget 2024-25 Highlights for Skill Development**

- **Increased Funding:** Allocation of additional funds for skill development programs, focusing on expanding training facilities, upgrading infrastructure, and enhancing the reach of existing schemes.
- **Expansion of PMKVY:** Enhanced funding for new initiatives under the PMKVY to train more individuals, especially in **emerging sectors like technology and green energy**.

- **Support for Digital Skills:** Investment in training programs related to digital skills, coding, and cybersecurity to address the growing demand for tech-savvy professionals.
- **Focus on Rural and Underserved Areas:** Special provisions for expanding skill development programs in rural and remote areas to ensure broader access and inclusivity.
- **Public-Private Partnerships:** Encouragement of more partnerships between the government and private sector to create job-oriented training programs and ensure alignment with industry needs.
- **Higher Education Integration:** Initiatives to integrate vocational training with higher education to provide students with both academic and practical skills.
- **Entrepreneurship Support:** Funding for programs that support entrepreneurial skill development, including mentorship, incubation centres, and financial assistance for start-ups.
- **Monitoring and Evaluation:** Investment in systems for better monitoring and evaluation of skill development programs to improve effectiveness and outcomes.

➤ **National Skill Development Policy, 2015**

- ✓ The National Skill Development Policy (NSDP), 2015, is a comprehensive framework introduced by the Government of India to enhance the country's skill development efforts.
- ✓ This policy aims to create a skilled workforce capable of meeting the demands of a rapidly changing job market and contributing to overall economic growth.
- ✓ **Key Objectives**
 - 1) Increased Skill Development
 - 2) Employment Generation
 - 3) Economic Growth
 - 4) Inclusive Growth
- ✓ **Key Components**
 - 1) **National Skill Development Mission:** Establishment of a centralized mission to oversee and coordinate various skill development initiatives and ensure effective implementation.
 - 2) **Skill Development Institutions:** Strengthening existing institutions and creating new ones to provide quality training. This includes upgrading Industrial Training Institutes (ITIs), polytechnics, and vocational training centres.
 - 3) **Sector Skill Councils (SSCs):** Formation of SSCs to identify sector-specific skill requirements, develop National Occupational Standards (NOS), and create training programs aligned with industry needs.
 - 4) **Certification and Accreditation:** Establishing a robust system for certifying and accrediting training programs to ensure that they meet quality standards and are recognized by employers.

- 5) **Public-Private Partnerships:** Encouragement of collaborations between the government, private sector, and industry stakeholders to design and deliver training programs that are relevant to market needs.
- 6) **Skill Development for Youth:** Special focus on youth, including school dropouts and unemployed graduates, to provide them with vocational training and enhance their employability.
- 7) **Integration with Education:** Integration of skill development into the formal education system, including vocational training as part of the school and higher education curriculum.
- 8) **Use of Technology:** Leveraging technology and digital platforms to enhance training delivery, including e-learning and online skill development resources.
- 9) **Financial Support:** Provision of financial support for skill development initiatives, including funding for training programs, scholarships, and incentives for trainers and institutions.
- 10) **Monitoring and Evaluation:** Implementation of a monitoring and evaluation framework to assess the effectiveness of skill development programs and make necessary adjustments.

✓ **Impact and Implementation**

- The NSDP, 2015, aims to address the skills gap in the Indian workforce by promoting a more systematic and coordinated approach to skill development.
- It emphasizes the need for a demand-driven approach, where training programs are closely aligned with the needs of various industries.
- The policy also supports the establishment of a National Skill Development Agency (NSDA) to coordinate and oversee the implementation of skill development programs and ensure alignment with national goals.
- Overall, the NSDP, 2015, represents a significant step towards building a more skilled and capable workforce in India, capable of meeting the challenges of a dynamic global economy.

➤ **Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY)**

- ✓ The **Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY)** is a flagship skill development program launched by the Government of India in 2015.
- ✓ The scheme aims to provide industry-relevant skill training to youth across the country, thereby enhancing their employability and contributing to the overall development of the economy.

✓ **Key Features of the Scheme**

1. **Training Programs:** PMKVY offers short-term training programs in various trades and sectors. These programs are designed to be industry-relevant and provide practical skills that are directly applicable to the job market.
2. **Certification:** Trainees who successfully complete the program are awarded a certificate that is recognized by industry bodies and employers. This certification helps validate their skills and enhances their job prospects.

3. **Financial Support:** The scheme provides financial support to training providers, which helps cover the costs of training and ensures that programs are accessible to a wider audience. This includes incentives for trainers and training centres.
 4. **Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL):** PMKVY also includes a component for recognizing and certifying the skills of individuals who have prior work experience but lack formal certification. This helps in formalizing their skills and improving their employability.
 5. **Public-Private Partnerships:** The program encourages collaboration between the government, private sector, and industry stakeholders to design and deliver training programs that meet current market needs.
 6. **Technology Integration:** PMKVY leverages technology to facilitate the delivery of training programs, including the use of online platforms and digital tools for learning and assessment.
 7. **Focus Areas:** The scheme covers a wide range of sectors, including manufacturing, services, and agriculture, with an emphasis on high-demand skills that can lead to immediate job opportunities.
- ✓ **Implementation of PMKVY:**
- PMKVY is implemented through the NSDC, which oversees the coordination and management of training programs and ensures quality standards.
 - PMKVY has trained millions of youths across India since its launch contributing to the development of a skilled workforce. The program has played a significant role in improving the employability of individuals and supporting the growth of various industries.

➤ **National Skill Development Corporation**

- ✓ The **National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC)** is a public-private partnership (PPP) established by the Government of India.
- ✓ It plays a central role in facilitating and promoting skill development and vocational training across the country.
- ✓ NSDC is governed by a Board of Directors, which includes representatives from the government, private sector, and other stakeholders.
- ✓ The corporation operates under the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship.
- ✓ **Objectives** - Enhance Skill Development, Promote Public-Private Partnerships, Boost Employability & Support Innovation
- ✓ **Functions of NSDC**
 - **Funding and Investment:** NSDC provides funding and investment to training providers, including private companies, non-governmental organizations (NGOs), and educational institutions.
 - **Accreditation and Certification:** It accredits training providers and ensures that training programs meet national standards. NSDC also collaborates with Sector

Skill Councils (SSCs) to develop National Occupational Standards (NOS) and certification frameworks.

- **Implementation of Skill Development Programs:** NSDC implements and oversees various skill development programs and initiatives, including the Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY) and other schemes aimed at enhancing employability and entrepreneurship.
- **Sector Skill Councils (SSCs):** NSDC works with SSCs to identify sector-specific skill needs, develop training curricula, and align training programs with industry requirements.
- **Innovation and Technology:** It promotes the use of technology and innovative methods in skill development, including e-learning platforms, virtual training, and digital tools.
- **Monitoring and Evaluation:** NSDC monitors and evaluates the effectiveness of training programs to ensure quality and impact. It conducts assessments to measure outcomes and make improvements.

➤ **Relationship between education, skill development & Employment**

- ✓ **Foundation of Skills:** Education provides the foundational knowledge and cognitive abilities necessary for acquiring specific skills. For instance, basic literacy and numeracy skills, learned through primary and secondary education, are essential for further technical and vocational training.
- ✓ **Critical Thinking and Problem-Solving:** Education enhances cognitive skills such as critical thinking and problem-solving, which are essential for effectively applying and adapting acquired skills in the workplace.
- ✓ **Enhancing Employability:** Skill development programs focus on equipping individuals with specific competencies that are in demand by employers. By aligning training with industry requirements, these programs increase the employability of individuals and prepare them for the job market.
- ✓ **Seamless Transition:** A well-integrated education and skill development system facilitates a seamless transition from education to employment. By providing career counselling, internships, and industry exposure during education, students are better prepared for skill development programs and subsequent employment.
- ✓ **Lifelong Learning:** The concept of lifelong learning bridges education, skill development, and employment. Continuous upgradation of skills through education and training ensures that individuals remain relevant in the workforce and adapt to changing industry needs.
- ✓ **Sector-Specific Training:** Skill development programs often focus on specific sectors, providing targeted training that addresses industry-specific needs. This enhances productivity and competitiveness within those sectors by ensuring a skilled workforce.

➤ **Challenges & Issues associated with skill development in India**

- ✓ **Mismatch Between Skills and Job Market Needs**

- **Industry Requirements:** There is often a gap between the skills being taught and the skills required by employers. Rapid technological changes and evolving industry needs can exacerbate this mismatch.
- **Curriculum Relevance:** Many training programs and educational curricula are not updated frequently enough to align with current industry standards and technological advancements.
- ✓ **Quality of Training Programs**
 - **Inadequate Infrastructure:** Many training institutions suffer from outdated or insufficient infrastructure, including training equipment and facilities.
 - **Trainer Quality:** The effectiveness of training programs is dependent on the quality of trainers. Inadequate training for trainers can lead to poor instruction and limited skill acquisition.
- ✓ **Access and Inclusivity**
 - **Geographical Disparities:** Skill development programs are often concentrated in urban areas, leaving rural and remote regions with limited access to quality training.
 - **Socio-Economic Barriers:** Marginalized and economically disadvantaged groups may face barriers in accessing skill development programs, including financial constraints and lack of information.
- ✓ **Lack of Industry Collaboration**
 - **Limited Industry Engagement:** Effective skill development requires strong collaboration between educational institutions, training providers, and industries. A lack of industry engagement can result in training programs that do not meet market needs.
 - **Internship and Apprenticeship Opportunities:** Insufficient opportunities for practical experience, such as internships and apprenticeships, can limit the real-world application of skills.
- ✓ **Funding and Resource Constraints**
 - **Insufficient Funding:** Many skill development programs face budget constraints that limit their ability to expand and improve. This can impact the quality of training and the scale of programs.
 - **Resource Allocation:** Inefficient allocation of resources can lead to underfunded programs and inadequate support for training initiatives.
- ✓ **Retention and Completion Rates**
 - **Dropout Rates:** High dropout rates from training programs can be a result of various factors, including lack of motivation, financial constraints, and poor program quality.
 - **Retention Challenges:** Ensuring that trained individuals remain in the workforce and apply their skills effectively can be challenging.
- ✓ **Technological Challenges**

- **Digital Divide:** Limited access to technology and digital platforms in some areas can restrict the reach of online and digital skill development programs.
- **Rapid Technological Change:** Keeping training programs up to date with rapid technological advancements can be challenging and resource intensive.
- ✓ **Employment Outcomes**
 - **Underemployment:** Even after completing skill development programs, individuals may face challenges in finding suitable employment or may be underemployed in roles that do not fully utilize their skills.
 - **Job Market Dynamics:** Fluctuations in the job market and economic conditions can impact the availability of employment opportunities for skilled individuals.
- **Way Forward**
 - ✓ Addressing these challenges requires a comprehensive approach that includes improving **the quality and relevance of training programs, enhancing access and inclusivity, fostering industry collaboration, and ensuring adequate funding and resources.**
 - ✓ By tackling these issues, India can build **a more effective and inclusive skill development ecosystem** that supports economic growth and development.

Questions

1. **Demographic Dividend in India will remain only theoretical unless our manpower becomes more educated, aware, skilled, and creative.” What measures have been taken by the government to enhance the capacity of our population to be more productive and employable?**
2. **Skill development programmes have succeeded in increasing human resources supply to various sectors. In the context of the statement analyse the linkages between education, skill, and employment.**

